party has its own status quo, and I suspect—like Mahatma Gandhi had to keep doing with (and through) the Congress—more such ideologically motivated programmes will be needed.

In making this suggestion, I hark back to what Rahul has long been advocating—permanent institutional change. Creating new systems that last the test of time has been the core of his political approach. His experiments with transforming the student and youth wing; with the primaries; during many reforms when he was party president; and with the Yatra keep reinforcing his focus on professionalizing the Congress party. The Yatra played a crucial role in precipitating change through disruption. Perhaps another Yatra (from west to east) may add to this disruption and tempo. But the lasting outcome of the Yatra is to *institutionalize* changes. Every decision-making body (at different levels), from the Congress Working Committee to the Pradesh Congress Committee to the district, block and booth committees, needs to completely recalibrate their way of functioning. Like during the freedom struggle, we face the full force of the State. Plus, there are major sociocultural regressions in the nation that won't be resolved overnight. Yet, the Congress party culture is still limited to self-promotion and interpersonal differences rather than ideological, intellectual and larger issues. Rahul Gandhi has rightly been impatient with this culture and strived to make the party more democratic, ideologically sharp and disruptive—all three values that the Yatra taught us. We have to recognize and accept the emergence of disquiet among leaders and party workers who strongly feel the need to do meaningful work. Without constructively channelizing them in ideological work that transcends electoral and routine political work (dharnas, pradarshans, etc.), they will naturally feel adrift. If they are to stay on only for electoral success and the fruits of governance, eventually they will (as they have been) desert the party for other pastures. In that sense, the Yatra showed us that there was a way to do politics beyond the electoral. And I know for a fact that many who claim to be close to the leadership were quietly critical of how radical the Yatra was to their way of thinking and operating. But I feel this was long needed. Rahul forced the party to take a long, hard look at itself in the mirror. By personal